



Better proximity sensor?

Software from Elliptic Labs plans to replace infrared proximity sensors with ultrasound sensors. <http://dgit.in/UltraSoundPS>



S Pen issue fixed

Samsung has physically changed the Note 5's internal mechanism to avoid the S Pen issue. <http://dgit.in/SPenFix>

HOW WE TESTED

To test we chose three different ISPs from Delhi and Mumbai region, running the tests on all of these services. We compared their performance on a Windows PC and Apple MacBook, while on the mobile platform we tested all of their supported Android apps on a One Plus 2.

First, we took into account the obvious things, like the number of movies that each of these services offer, number of advertisements, if at all, that you have to see, the resolution they allow you to stream in, browsers and platforms that they support and whether you can cast them onto other screens. A lot of these apps also go the extra mile suggesting

things that you may like, which is another thing that we took into consideration. In addition, downloading content for offline viewing was of course given extra points.

The fact that all of these services offer mobile apps and run online in the form of web apps, is also something that was taken into consideration. How? We rated the apps, both on mobiles and desktops, based on their design. In the interest of full disclosure, it's important to mention that the design elements were not always rated objectively. The reason for that is how good something looks may change based on who's looking. To counter that, we picked representatives from

our Mumbai and Delhi teams and told them to rate the appearance of these apps. We then took an average of all of these scores.

Other design elements, like Search, System Resources consumed, how content is sorted, number of steps required to play stuff, were easier to rate objectively.

The most important part of this comparison though is the performance. To test this, we started with how much time it takes these services to launch content. To do this, we timed them, playing sub-30 minute videos and over-60 minute long videos, rating them based on the time they take to launch each of these videos. This is

important, since you won't really want to pay for a service that buffers right at the beginning right?

Next, we tried jumping to different parts of the video, timing them for how long it takes them to seek and buffer then. In addition, we also observed whether the content quality stuttered after seeking to a certain point, deducting points based on how often that happened. The same was also done on mobile.

Lastly, the video quality was rated, based on how often the resolution drops, whether the app starts streaming at the highest quality throughout or plays catch up, whether it buffers too often and so on.

WINNERS

BEST BUY: Eros Now

Eros International's Eros Now has a healthy collection of movies, TV Shows and regional content and when combined with a pretty seamless streaming experience, is our pick for the best buy award. You can try out the free version to

start with, but having subscribed to every service on this test, we're continuing this one for a while longer. Given Eros Now's consistent, high class performance and its unbeatable library of latest and relevant Indian content, at ₹99 per month for a premium subscription, this is a real steal!

BEST PERFORMER: Netflix

It wasn't surprising that Netflix lived up to its name, becoming the best performer on our test. It was the only streaming video service which consistently provided HD streams (from the beginning or jumped to a

particular point in the video) without a hitch, unlike almost every other service in the test which almost always started off with a SD quality video catching up to better quality after half a minute. Among its competitors, only Eros Now came close to matching Netflix's video performance.

EDITOR'S PICK: Hotstar

If on demand video streaming is to replace regular television then Hotstar has the right idea on how to do it. We found this service interesting and worth using and the fact that it's available for free means you could try it with no strings attached, too. Hotstar's live television is its best feature and we hope it is able to get exclusive content to drive viewers in future.



EROS NOW

PROS:

- Huge Indian content collection
- Good performance
- Inexpensive

CONS:

- Limited Hollywood content
- Sub-stellar mobile performance



NETFLIX

PROS:

- Best, consistent HD quality
- Attractive interface
- Exclusive content

CONS:

- Expensive
- Entire Netflix US content missing



HOTSTAR

PROS:

- Free
- Live TV broadcast
- Very good streaming quality

CONS:

- Limited English content
- Below par desktop performance